

Believed or Shared

The book splits every asset into two intensities by asking one question: does this have to be believed, or reposted? Founders who ask it before writing stop sending the wrong document.



FROM THE BOOK

“Same DNA, different intensity, not two brands. Anything that has to be believed rather than shared.”

StartPad Brand Presentation, GrowthLabs Group, 2026 · Chapter 04 · The language, two intensities

One question decides the whole document.

The book divides its outputs into calm mode — documents, certificates, partnership and institutional material — and energy mode, for social, campaign and launch. The dividing line is not the audience or the channel. It is whether the thing has to be **believed** or **shared**, and those want opposite treatments.

HAS TO BE BELIEVED

An investor update or a data room

An application to a programme

A customer proposal or a quote

A partnership memorandum

Anything a lawyer or a committee will read

HAS TO BE SHARED

A launch post

A hiring call

An event announcement

A milestone your customers should see

Anything whose job is to be forwarded

Same company, same facts, opposite treatment. The failure is almost never the writing — it is a document built for one column being sent to the other.

Restraint is a feature of one and a fault in the other.

	BELIEVED	SHARED
Length	As long as the evidence needs. Nothing decorative.	One idea. Cut until only it is left.
Numbers	Every one sourced, dated, with a denominator.	One number, chosen because it is memorable.
Tone	Flat. The facts carry it; adjectives subtract.	Warm. It has to be worth somebody's reputation to forward.
Design	Plain. A document that must be believed is not decorated.	Loud. It is competing in a feed.
What it opens with	The requirement, or the bad news.	The thing that makes somebody stop scrolling.
Success looks like	Nobody asks a follow-up question you cannot answer.	Somebody who does not know you passes it on.

The most common mistake in this market

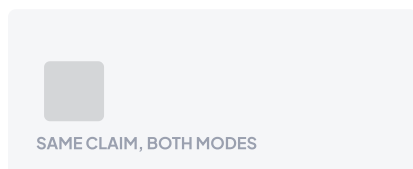
Sending an energy-mode document to a believed-mode reader. A deck full of adjectives, big claims and no denominators reads as a campaign to an investment committee, and a committee that thinks it is being marketed to stops reading the numbers.

The rarer mistake, and its cost

The inverse also happens: a founder writes a launch post the way they would write a memorandum. Careful, sourced, hedged — and nobody shares it, because there is nothing in it worth attaching your name to. Accuracy is not the constraint in the shared column. Being worth forwarding is.

Not two brands. Not two founders.

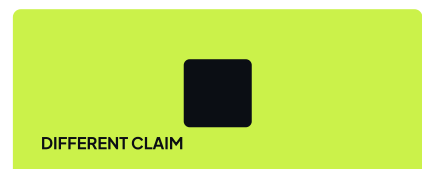
The book is careful to say these are one system at two intensities. The founder equivalent matters: the claims must be identical in both modes. A shared post that says something the believed document would not support is not a different intensity — it is a different company, and in a market this small the two audiences overlap.



The only safe position. What you post is what the data room would support, said more loudly.



A claim the document would soften. Survives until somebody who read both compares them.



Two companies. The moment an investor sees the post and the deck together, everything else is re-read.

The book's phrase is the useful one: same DNA, different intensity, not two brands.

Intensity may change; the claim may not. Egypt's ecosystem is small enough that both audiences meet, usually sooner than the founder expects.

Worksheet · Mode check

TWO MINUTES, BEFORE SENDING

Run this on the next thing you are about to send to somebody outside the company.

Does this have to be believed, or shared? One word.

If believed — which claim in it is unsourced?

Source it or cut it. There is no third option in this column.

If shared — what is the one idea, and what can go?

If you cannot name one idea, it is not ready to be shared.

Would the other mode's version of this contradict it?

If yes, fix the claim, not the wording.

- ☐ **The believed version opens with the requirement or the bad news**

Not with context, and not with momentum.

- ☐ **Every number in the believed version has a source and a denominator**

A number without a denominator is a claim wearing a number's clothes.

- ☐ **The shared version carries exactly one idea**

Two ideas in a post means neither is remembered.

- ☐ **Nothing in the shared version would need softening in the believed one**

Same DNA. This is the check that protects both.

- ☐ **Neither version contains a promise about funding**

The book lists this among what the brand refuses, and it is good advice for a founder.

SAY	NEVER SAY
11 of 34 paid a deposit in April.	Incredible response from the market!
We missed the target and here is why.	Lots of exciting progress!
They grew 40%; we handled the logistics.	We grew our client 40%.
Accepted into the cohort, March.	We're going to be huge.

The book lists what the voice refuses: hype, cheerleading, startup romanticism, and promises about funding. All four are energy-mode habits that leak into believed-mode documents, which is where they do the damage.



StartPad tells you the truth about whether you are ready, gets you ready, and gives you the proof.

What it is

A founder-readiness platform for Egypt and the wider MENA region. It takes a young person who has an idea and no company, moves them through fifteen structured missions, and turns them into someone the ecosystem will take seriously — then issues verifiable proof of that.

It is not a course platform, not an education brand and not a youth club. Nothing here is graded. Every mission ends in an artefact you own.

Three moves, always in this order

TRUTH Where you actually stand

Measured against what programmes actually ask for, stated plainly, before any encouragement.

READINESS Fifteen structured missions

They close the specific gaps the assessment found, in the order that matters. A route, not a curriculum.

PROOF A verifiable credential

The ecosystem can check it without asking you. You apply with a file, not a hope.

On your idea

StartPad earns when a founder gets into somewhere — an accelerator, a programme, a room. Taking a founder's idea would end that. Work submitted to a mission is sealed and timestamped to the person who submitted it, and the seal is the product.

Nothing in this document asks you to give anything up to use it. It is yours to fill in, print, and hand to whoever needs to see it.

startpad.me

Start with the readiness assessment. It is free and it takes about twenty minutes.